



Kodak Android phone

Kodak will be unveiling a new Android smartphone at the CES 2015 event. Are they too late? <http://dgit.in/KodakPhone>



Best earth images

Check out the best images of the earth taken by the fleet of satellites owned by NASA <http://dgit.in/NASAIImages>

WIN PC Maintenance

Learn about fixing your everyday PC troubles, and the tools to maintain it

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It has happened to all of us. You've a presentation to submit the day after, you hover your mouse or click on the power button, and the unthinkable happens. The system just won't comply with your wishes. Either it will keep looping around a blue screen, or will act so slow that you literally can't do any work on it, or worse, it just won't turn on.

With complex operating systems these days, pointing out the culprit is never straightforward and the steps we've outlined here are suited for a more general approach. Remember, Google is your friend! That being said, let's check out some of the most common problems users face.

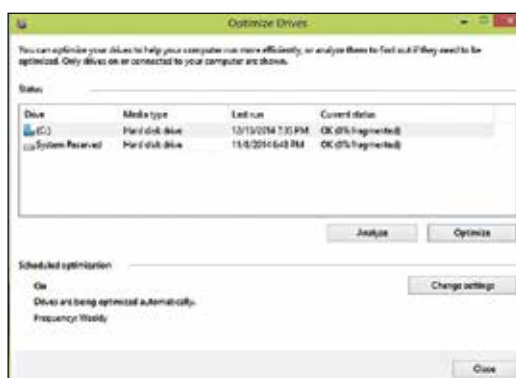
Everyday issues

Speed and performance glitches

Issue: CPU is slow, or unstable, or always under heavy load

If you've recently mounted a new motherboard, or installed a new operating system, you may want to check the BIOS for any improper configuration. You can try the freeware utilities like CPU-Z (<http://dgit.in/CPUzID>) and Cinebench (<http://dgit.in/MCinebench>) to check if your CPU is working fine by comparing it with results of others' over the web.

That would be helpful if your CPU is slow. But what if it's unstable? That's a rather more concerning possibility. If your computer, however, is exhibiting such symptoms,



In Windows 10, the defragmenting tool also lets you optimise the system.

you need to check the temperature first and then test stability by running Prime95 (<http://dgit.in/Prime95>) alone. If it ends up showing a blue-screen to you, your CPU is probably heating too much. Else, you should the RAM modules and for that, you can try Memtest86+ (<http://dgit.in/Memtest86>). If that too isn't the problem, the next component you should check is the PSU (Power Supply Unit). When the PSU fails to provide the right amount of voltage to the motherboard it can also make the system unstable.

But what if your system always seems to be under too much stress? In other

words, it is hogging too much resources at every instance of time even when you know you aren't doing anything. This could be the work of a malware. Try installing the free or trial version of AVG (<http://dgit.in/AVAVG>), or ESET, and run a complete scan to hunt down the malware.



GPU is slow

If your system's graphics has all of a sudden become cumbersome, this could be a software compatibility issue. The first thing you'll need to do is check the GPU temperature using GPU-Z. Then update your graphics drivers as a recent update might have messed things up. Sometimes your GPU is simply not powerful enough and is heating up. It is probably in your best interest if you didn't play the latest AAA game but if it is too important and you know your ways, you may also try over-

clocking (<http://dgit.in/WAPCOVerClock>) to increase the device's efficiency.

Critical issues

Issue: Windows is freezing or slowing down

Freezing is one of the most common and frustrating issues our computers run into every few months. It happens for a myriad of reasons with a common cause being insufficient processor cooling. Generally, it's when the CPU fan gets clogged up with too much dust, or when the thermal paste between the sink and processor has dried up. Cleaning and replacing the thermal paste should help.

Additionally, loose cables and components can also degrade the performance, so you will want to check and tighten everything right. Also, in case you'd overclocked your CPU or GPU recently, you should restore it to normal if it continues to heat up.

If your computer has also slowed down recently, you need to check the task manager to know which process is at fault and uninstall or temporarily stop it. Also, browsers with too many extensions and plugins installed consume a lot of resources.